

Absolutely — **colour** is a strong target because your passage uses it figuratively:

> “...it adds **colour**, calm, and meaning to her everyday life.”

Here **colour** does **not** mean literal red/blue/green pigment only. It means **variety, interest, vividness, and emotional richness** added to life.

Word family: **colour / coloured / colourful / colourless / colouring**

Base word: colour

American spelling: color

Verb forms: colour, colours, coloured, colouring

Related forms: colourful, colourless, colouring

Useful compounds / expressions: colour scheme, colour code, colour blind, local colour, in colour, off-colour

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “...because it adds **colour**, calm, and meaning to her everyday life.”

Meaning in your passage: **colour = interest / variety / vividness — 色彩 ; 情趣 ; 豐富感**

Here **colour** means:

> **qualities that make life more interesting, varied, vivid, or emotionally rich.**

繁體中文 :

令生活變得更有趣、更豐富、更生動的元素 ; 色彩、情趣、豐富感

Natural translation:

> “It adds colour, calm, and meaning to her everyday life.”

「這為她的日常生活**增添了色彩、平靜和意義**。」

So here:

> **add colour to life = 為生活增添情趣、變化和生氣**

1. **colour = visible hue (顏色) — 顏色 ; 色彩**

The core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “What **colour** are the flowers?”

「這些花是甚麼**顏色**？」

Practice 2

> “The room is decorated in warm colours.”

「房間以溫暖的**色調 / 顏色**裝飾。」

colour = 人眼感受到的紅、藍、綠、黃等視覺色彩特徵

2. **colour** = particular shade/tone (色調) — 色調；色澤

A more specific branch.

Practice 3

> “The leaves changed **colour** in autumn.”

「葉子在秋天變了**顏色 / 色澤**。」

Practice 4

> “The paint has a soft natural colour.”

「這種油漆有柔和自然的**色調**。」

colour = 某物所呈現的具體色調或色澤

3. **colour** = vividness / interest / variety (比喻) — 色彩；情趣；生氣

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 5 — Original

> “Gardening adds **colour** to her everyday life.”

「園藝為她的日常生活**增添色彩 / 情趣**。」

Practice 6

> “Travel adds colour to life.”

「旅行為生活**增添色彩和趣味**。」

Practice 7

> “Her stories brought colour to the history lesson.”

「她的故事令歷史課**變得更生動有趣**。」

****colour — figurative = 令某事更生動、有趣、多樣化或更有情感層次的元素****

4. ****colour = detailed vivid character in description (描寫) — 生動細節 ; 地方特色****

A useful abstract noun sense.

Practice 8

> “The writer adds ****colour**** with small everyday details.”

「作者透過日常小細節讓描寫更****生動****。」

Practice 9

> “The interview gave the report more colour.”

「這次訪問令報告多了一些****生動細節 / 人情味****。」

****colour = 令敘述、報告或故事更具體、生動和富有人情味的細節****

5. ****local colour (地方特色) — 地方色彩 ; 地方風情****

A common literary/travel expression.

Practice 10

> “The market gives the town plenty of ****local colour****.”

「這個市場為城鎮增添很多**地方風情**。」

Practice 11

> “The novel is full of local colour.”

「這本小說充滿**地方特色 / 地方色彩**。」

****local colour = 某地獨特的風俗、人物、語言、景觀和生活氣息****

6. ****colour = complexion / skin tone (膚色 / 氣色) — 膚色 ; 氣色 ; 紅潤****

Practice 12

> “The cold brought some ****colour**** to her cheeks.”

「寒冷令她的雙頰有了些****紅潤氣色****。」

Practice 13

> “He lost colour in his face when he heard the news.”

「他聽到消息後臉色變得****蒼白 / 失去血色****。」

****colour = 臉部或皮膚因血液循環、健康、情緒等呈現的色澤****

7. ****colour = natural pigment in skin/hair/etc. (天然色素 / 顏色) — 色澤 ; 色素****

Practice 14

> “The fruit develops a deeper ****colour**** as it ripens.”

「水果成熟時會呈現更深的****色澤****。」

Practice 15

> “The flower has very little natural colour.”

「這種花本身的天然****色澤****很淡。」

****colour = 生物或物件天然呈現出的色素 / 顏色****

8. **colour = pigment/dye/paint substance (顏料 / 染料) — 顏料 ; 染料**

A material sense.

Practice 16

> “Add a little food **colour** to the icing.”

「在糖霜中加入少量食用**色素**。」

Practice 17

> “The artist mixed several colours.”

「畫家混合了幾種**顏料**。」

colour = 用來產生、改變或加深顏色的顏料、染料或色素

9. **colour = verb, make something a particular colour — 給.....上色 ; 染色**

Now **colour** is a verb.

Practice 18

> “The children **coloured** the picture.”

「孩子們替圖畫**上色**。」

Practice 19

> “The sunset coloured the sky orange.”

「夕陽把天空**染成橙色**。」

colour = 使某物呈現某種顏色，或替某物上色 / 染色

10. **colour = affect/bias someone's judgment (比喻動詞) — 影響 ; 左右 ; 使帶偏見**

A major figurative verb sense.

Practice 20

> “Past experience can **colour** our judgment.”

「過往經驗可能會**影響 / 左右**我們的判斷。」

Practice 21

> “His opinion was coloured by personal feelings.”

「他的看法受到個人感情**影響 / 染上主觀色彩**。」

colour — figurative verb = 使看法、判斷或描述受到情緒、經驗或偏見影響

This is a very important academic/literary meaning.

11. **colour = influence the tone/character of something — 使帶有某種色彩 / 基調**

Closely related to #10.

Practice 22

> “Her childhood memories **colour** much of her writing.”

「她的童年回憶為她很多作品**染上特定色彩 / 基調**。」

Practice 23

> “Humour colours the whole conversation.”

「幽默感為整段對話**增添了一種特定基調**。」

colour = 令某事帶有某種情緒、風格、態度或特色

This shares the same core figurative concept as “influence,” so I would merge them conceptually.

12. **colourful = full of bright colours (外觀) — 色彩繽紛的 ; 鮮豔的**

Practice 24

> “The garden is full of **colourful** flowers.”

「花園裡滿是**色彩繽紛的花朵**。」

Practice 25

> “She wore a colourful dress.”

「她穿了一條**色彩鮮豔的裙子**。」

colourful = 含有很多鮮明或不同顏色的

13. **colourful = interesting / lively / full of character (人物 / 故事) — 生動有趣的；多姿多彩的**

A major figurative adjective.

Practice 26

> “He had a **colourful life**.”

「他的人生非常**多姿多彩 / 充滿故事**。」

Practice 27

> “She is one of the most colourful characters in the book.”

「她是書中最**鮮明有趣、個性十足**的角色之一。」

colourful — figurative = 經歷、個性或內容豐富、生動、有趣而令人印象深刻的

14. **colourful = involving scandal/crime/excitement (委婉) — 精彩但複雜的；充滿爭議的**

A subtle figurative branch.

Practice 28

> “The politician had a **colourful past**.”

「那名政治人物有一段**複雜、充滿爭議的過去**。」

Practice 29

> “His colourful history attracted media attention.”

「他那段**充滿故事、甚至帶爭議的經歷**吸引了媒體注意。」

****colourful — euphemistic = 經歷豐富，但可能包含爭議、冒險、醜聞或不尋常事件****

Context matters.

15. ****colourless = without colour (外觀) — 無色的；缺乏色彩的****

Practice 30

> “The liquid is ****colourless****.”

「這種液體是****無色的****。」

Practice 31

> “The gas is colourless and odourless.”

「這種氣體****無色無味****。」

****colourless = 沒有可見顏色的****

16. ****colourless = dull / lacking personality (比喻) — 平淡無趣的；缺乏個性的****

Practice 32

> “The speech was accurate but ****colourless****.”

「這場演講雖然準確，但很****平淡乏味****。」

Practice 33

> “The character felt rather colourless.”

「這個角色感覺相當****缺乏個性 / 毫無特色****。」

****colourless — figurative = 缺乏生氣、特色、情感或個性的****

17. ****colouring = act/activity of adding colour — 填色；著色****

Practice 34

> “The children spent the afternoon **colouring**.”

「孩子們下午都在**填色 / 畫畫上色**。」

Practice 35

> “Colouring can be relaxing.”

「**填色活動**可以令人放鬆。」

colouring = 替圖畫、形狀等加上顏色的活動 / 過程

18. **colouring** = natural/artificial colouring of something — 色澤；著色；色素

Practice 36

> “The bird has unusual **colouring**.”

「這隻鳥的**羽毛色澤 / 配色**很特別。」

Practice 37

> “The product contains artificial colouring.”

「這件產品含有人工**色素 / 著色劑**。」

colouring = 某物呈現的整體顏色特徵，或用來使其著色的物質

19. **colour scheme** (設計) — 配色方案；色彩搭配

Practice 38

> “The room has a simple **colour scheme**.”

「這個房間採用簡潔的**配色方案**。」

Practice 39

> “The designer changed the colour scheme.”

「設計師更改了**色彩搭配**。」

****colour scheme = 設計中有系統地選擇、搭配的一組顏色****

20. ****colour code (系統 / 標示) — 色碼 ; 用顏色分類****

Practice 40

> “The files are ****colour-coded**** by category.”

「檔案按類別以****顏色編碼 / 分類****。」

Practice 41

> “The hospital uses a colour code for different zones.”

「醫院用****顏色代碼****區分不同區域。」

****colour code = 用不同顏色代表不同類別、狀態或功能的標示系統****

21. ****colour-coded = 按顏色分類 / 標示的****

Practice 42

> “The map is ****colour-coded****.”

「地圖採用****顏色分類標示****。」

Practice 43

> “Each team uses a colour-coded label.”

「每隊使用不同的****顏色標籤****。」

****colour-coded = 使用顏色來區分、分類或辨識資訊的****

22. ****in colour = in colours rather than black and white — 彩色的 ; 以彩色呈現****

Practice 44

> “The photographs were printed ****in colour****.”

「照片是以****彩色****印刷的。」

Practice 45

> “The film was shot in colour.”

「這部電影是以****彩色****拍攝的。」

****in colour** = 以完整顏色呈現，而不是黑白******

23. ****off-colour / off-color** (健康) — 身體不適的；氣色不佳的******

A useful idiom, especially BrE.

Practice 46

> “You look a bit ****off-colour**** today.”

「你今天看起來有點****不舒服 / 氣色不太好****。」

Practice 47

> “She felt off-colour and went home early.”

「她覺得****身體不太舒服****，所以提早回家。」

****off-colour** = 身體有點不適、狀態不佳******

24. ****off-colour** = slightly rude/indecent (內容) — 有點粗俗 / 不雅的******

Another established sense.

Practice 48

> “He made an ****off-colour joke****.”

「他講了一個****有點粗俗 / 不雅的笑話****。」

Practice 49

> “The comment was considered off-colour.”

「那句評論被認為有點**不得體 / 粗俗**。」

****off-colour — content = 帶有性、粗俗或不太適宜內容的****

Excellent contrast with the health meaning.

25. ****show one's true colours (成語) — 顯露真面目 ; 露出本性****

Practice 50

> “He showed his ****true colours**** when the situation became difficult.”

「情況變困難時，他終於****顯露真面目****。」

Practice 51

> “Pressure often makes people show their true colours.”

「壓力常會令人****顯露真正本性****。」

****show one's true colours = 在某種情況下暴露真正性格、態度或意圖****

26. ****with flying colours (成語) — 以優異成績 ; 非常成功地****

Practice 52

> “She passed the exam ****with flying colours****.”

「她以****優異成績****通過考試。」

Practice 53

> “The team completed the project with flying colours.”

「團隊****非常成功地****完成了項目。」

****with flying colours = 表現非常出色地完成 / 通過某事****

27. **nail one's colours to the mast (較文學 / BrE) — 公開表明立場**

A genuine idiom, but more advanced.

Practice 54

> “He finally nailed his colours to the mast.”

「他終於**公開表明自己的立場**。」

Practice 55

> “She was willing to nail her colours to the mast on the issue.”

「她願意就這個議題**公開表明立場**。」

nail one's colours to the mast = 公開、明確地表明自己的立場，並願意堅持它

Register: idiomatic, somewhat literary/BrE.

Important distinction: **colour vs shade**

colour

broad:

red, blue, green, etc.

shade

a particular lighter/darker version of a colour.

> blue = colour

> navy blue = shade of blue

So:

> colour = 顏色

> shade = 色調 / 深淺變化

Important distinction: **colour vs tone**

colour

general hue.

tone

can mean:

- * particular shade/quality of colour;
- * overall visual mood.

> warm colour

> warm tone

They overlap, but **tone** often emphasizes subtle quality or overall effect.

Important distinction: **colour vs pigment**

colour

visual property.

pigment

physical substance that produces colour.

> red colour

> = 紅色

> red pigment

> = 紅色色素 / 顏料

Important distinction: **colour vs dye**

dye

substance used to change colour, especially fabric/hair.

colour

broader visual property or colouring substance depending on context.

> hair dye

> = 染髮劑

> hair colour

> = 髮色

Important distinction: **colour vs colourful**

colour

noun:

> “The room needs more colour.”

colourful

adjective:

> “The room is colourful.”

So:

> colour = 色彩 / 情趣

> colourful = 色彩豐富 / 生動有趣

Important distinction: **colourful vs bright**

colourful

= contains many vivid/different colours.

bright

= high light intensity or vividness.

Something can be:

* bright but one colour;

* colourful but not especially bright.

Important distinction: **colourless vs transparent**

colourless

= no colour.

transparent

= light passes through so you can see through it.

A liquid can be:

* colourless but cloudy;

* coloured but transparent.

Different properties.

Important distinction: **colour vs character**

In figurative use:

colour

= vividness, interest, richness.

character

= distinctive qualities/personality.

> “The market adds colour to the area.”

= 令地區更有生氣 / 風情。

> “The old buildings give the area character.”

= 老建築令地區更有特色。

Closely related but not identical.

Important distinction: **colour vs meaning** in your sentence

Your source deliberately lists:

> **colour, calm, and meaning**

These are three different contributions:

* **colour** = 趣味、變化、生氣

* **calm** = 平靜感

* **meaning** = 意義 / 價值感

So **colour** here should not be translated merely as literal 「顏色」.

Important distinction: **colour — noun vs colour — verb**

Noun

> “I like the colour.”

= 我喜歡這個顏色。

Verb

> “Colour the picture.”

= 替圖畫上色。

Figurative verb

> “Emotion coloured his judgment.”

= 情緒影響了他的判斷。

Three very useful functions.

Important distinction: **colour vs color**

Same word, different standard spelling:

British English

> **colour**

American English

> **color**

Related:

- * colourful / colorful
- * colourless / colorless
- * colouring / coloring

Since your passage uses British-style vocabulary elsewhere, **colour** is the natural spelling here.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **colour — hue** = 顏色
- * **colour — shade/tone** = 色調 / 色澤
- * **colour — figurative vividness** = 色彩 / 情趣 / 生氣
- * **colour — descriptive detail** = 生動細節
- * **local colour** = 地方風情
- * **colour — complexion** = 氣色 / 血色
- * **colour — pigment/dye** = 顏料 / 色素
- * **colour — verb literal** = 上色 / 染色
- * **colour — verb figurative** = 影響 / 使帶偏見或特定基調
- * **colourful — literal** = 色彩繽紛
- * **colourful — figurative** = 多姿多彩 / 個性鮮明
- * **colourful — euphemistic** = 經歷複雜 / 充滿爭議
- * **colourless — literal** = 無色
- * **colourless — figurative** = 平淡乏味 / 缺乏個性
- * **colouring — activity** = 填色
- * **colouring — appearance/pigment** = 色澤 / 色素
- * **colour scheme** = 配色方案
- * **colour code** = 顏色編碼
- * **colour-coded** = 按顏色分類標示
- * **in colour** = 彩色呈現
- * **off-colour — health** = 身體不適
- * **off-colour — content** = 粗俗 / 不雅
- * **show one's true colours** = 顯露真面目
- * **with flying colours** = 以優異表現
- * **nail one's colours to the mast** = 公開表明立場

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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colour — hue	人眼感受到的紅、藍、綠等視覺顏色
colour — shade/tone	某物呈現的具體色調、色澤或深淺
colour — figurative vividness	令生活、故事或活動更有趣、更生動、更豐富的特質
colour — descriptive detail	令敘述或報告更具體、生動、有情感或人情味的細節
local colour	某地獨特的風俗、人物、語言和生活氣息
colour — complexion	臉部 / 皮膚因健康、情緒等呈現出的氣色或血色
colour — pigment	用來產生或改變顏色的顏料、染料或色素
colour — verb literal	使某物呈現某種顏色；替某物上色 / 染色
colour — verb figurative	使判斷、看法或描述受到情緒、經驗或偏見影響
colourful — literal	含有很多鮮明或不同顏色的
colourful — figurative	經歷、個性或內容豐富、生動、有趣的
colourless — literal	沒有可見顏色的
colourless — figurative	缺乏生氣、特色、情感或個性的
colouring — activity	替圖畫等加上顏色的活動
colouring — appearance/substance	某物的整體色澤，或令其著色的物質
colour scheme	設計中有系統搭配的一組顏色
colour code	用不同顏色代表類別、狀態或功能的標示系統
off-colour — health	身體有點不舒服、氣色不佳
off-colour — content	帶有粗俗、性暗示或不太適宜內容的
show one's true colours	在某情況下顯露真正性格、態度或意圖
with flying colours	以非常優異、成功的表現完成 / 通過某事

For your original sentence

> “Overall, I think she loves growing plants because it adds ****colour****, calm, and meaning to her everyday life.”

The exact meaning is:

****colour = 令她的日常生活變得更有趣、更豐富、更有生氣的元素****

So naturally:

> ****「總括來說，我覺得她喜歡種植物，是因為這為她的日常生活增添了色彩、平靜和意義。」****

Here ****色彩**** is figurative Chinese too — closer to:

> ****情趣 / 變化 / 生活的豐富感****

rather than merely literal visual colour.

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****colour of a flower**** → 花的顏色
- > ****add colour to life**** → 為生活增添情趣 / 生氣
- > ****colour someone's judgment**** → 影響某人的判斷
- > ****colourful clothes**** → 色彩繽紛的衣服
- > ****colourful life**** → 多姿多彩的人生
- > ****colourless liquid**** → 無色液體
- > ****colourless speech**** → 平淡乏味的演講
- > ****off-colour**** → 身體不適 ****或**** 粗俗不雅